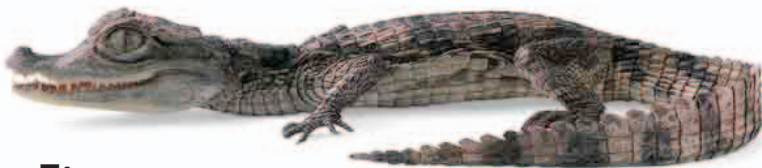


Crocodiles and alligators

Lurking beneath the water are the monsters of the reptile world. Meet the wild, ferocious crocodilians.

This animal is a caiman, a type of alligator that lives in Central and South America.



Fierce crocs

Crocodilians are large, meat-eating reptiles that live in water, but sometimes hunt on land as well. They all have very powerful jaws and teeth.

Crocodilians have three eyelids on each eye – one acts like goggles underwater.

Crocodilians

There are three types of crocodilians.



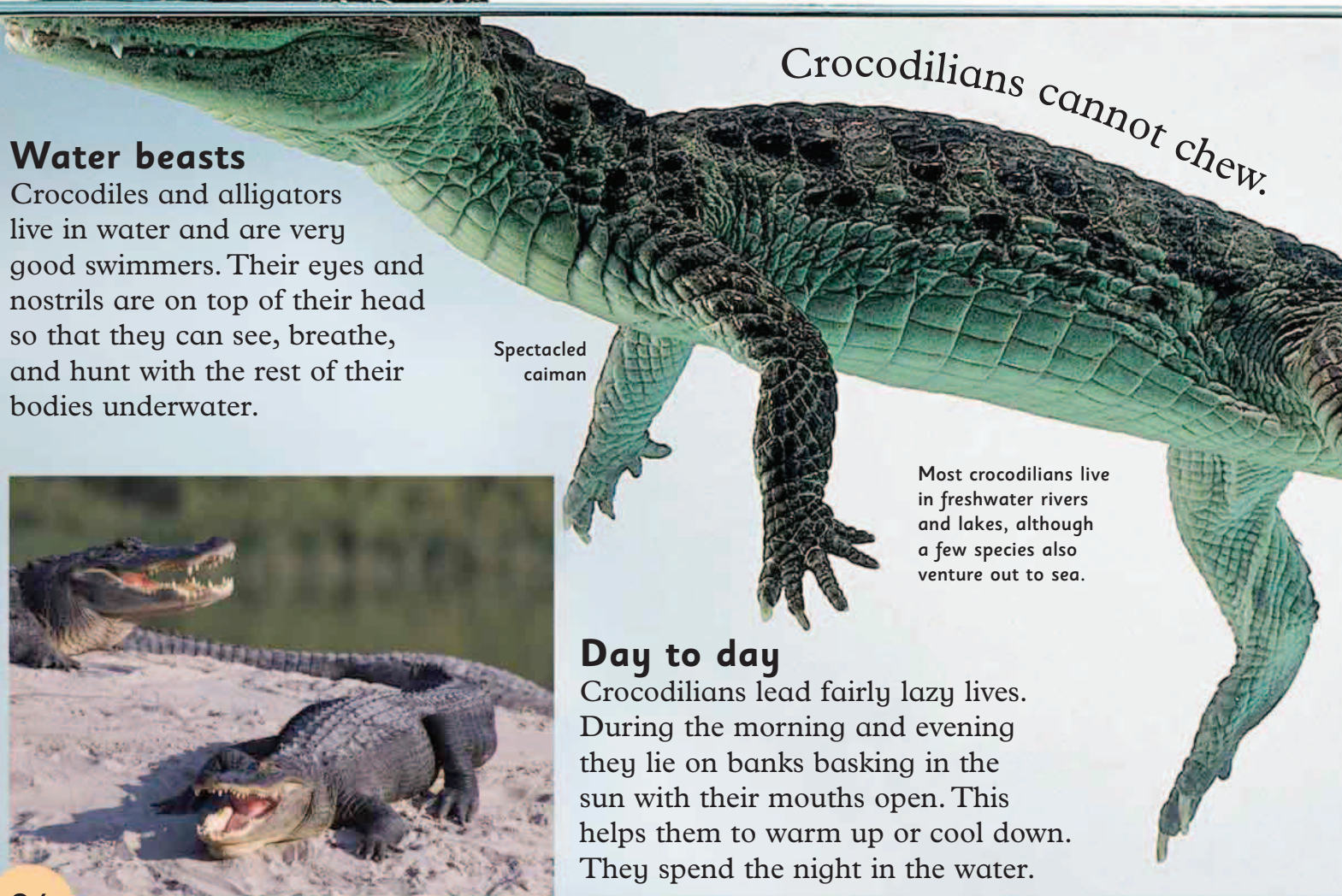
Gharial: this crocodilian has a long thin snout.



Alligator: it has a shorter, broader snout and lives in the Americas.



Crocodile: unlike the alligator, it has teeth showing when its mouth is closed.



Crocodilians cannot chew.

Water beasts

Crocodiles and alligators live in water and are very good swimmers. Their eyes and nostrils are on top of their head so that they can see, breathe, and hunt with the rest of their bodies underwater.

Spectacled caiman

Most crocodilians live in freshwater rivers and lakes, although a few species also venture out to sea.

Day to day

Crocodilians lead fairly lazy lives. During the morning and evening they lie on banks basking in the sun with their mouths open. This helps them to warm up or cool down. They spend the night in the water.

